metallic fluid inside the Earth's surface with a core of radius of about 3500 km compared to the Earth's radius of 6400 km.

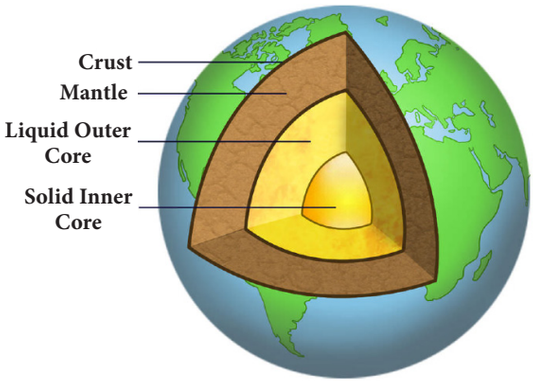


Figure 7.6 Core of the Earth

DO YOU KNOW?

Pigeons have extraordinary navigational abilities. It enables them to find their way back home even if you take them to a place where they have never been before. The presence of magnetite in their beaks enables them to sense the magnetic field of the Earth. Such a magnetic sense is called **magneto-reception.**

7.6.1 Earth's Magnetic Field

A freely suspended magnetic needle at a point on the Earth comes to rest approximately along the geographical north - south direction. This shows that the Earth behaves like a huge magnetic dipole with its magnetic poles located near its geographical poles. The north pole of a magnetic needle approximately points towards the geographic north (NG). Thus, it is appropriate to say that the magnetic north pole of the needle is attracted by the magnetic south pole of the Earth (Sm), which is located at the geographic north (NG). Also, the magnetic south pole of the needle is attracted by the magnetic north pole of the Earth (Nm), which is located at the geographic south (SG). The magnitude of the magnetic field strength at the Earth's surface ranges from 25 to 65 micro tesla.

DO YOU KNOW?

Earth's magnet is 20 times more powerful than a fridge magnet.

7.7 Uses of Magnets

We come into contact with magnets offen in our daily life. They are used in wide range of devices. Some of the uses of magnets are given below.

- In ancient times the magnet in the form of 'direction stone' were used by seamen to find the directions during a voyage.
- Nowadays, magnets are used to generate electricity in dynamos.
- Electromagnets are used in our day to day life.
- They are used in electric bells and electric motors.
- They are used in loudspeakers and microphones.
- An extremely powerful electromagnet is used in the fast moving Maglev train to remain floating above the tracks.
- In industries, magnetic conveyor belts are used to sort out magnetic substances from scraps mixed with non-magnetic substances.
- Magnets are used in computer in its storing devices such as hard disks.

DO YOU KNOW?

Maglev train (Magnetic levitation train) has no wheels. It floats above its tracks due to strong magnetic forces applied by computer controlled electromagnets. It is the fastest train in the world. The speed attained by this train is around 500 km/hr.



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